

Area of Study	Content	Learners should be able to:
External influences	Political factors	• identify political factors which influence a business • evaluate how the policies of local, national, EU and international governments can affect a business.
	Economics factors	• explain the key economic indicators which influence a business • identify the nature and purpose of the main types of taxation in the UK • distinguish between direct and indirect taxation • explain what is meant by Gross Domestic Product • evaluate the impact and importance in changes in economic factors for a business and its stakeholders.
	Social factors	• describe social factors which influence a business • evaluate the impact and importance in changes in social factors for a business and its stakeholders.
	Technological factors	• identify technological factors which influence a business • explain how technology can be used in a business • explain how changes in technology may impact on a business • evaluate the opportunities and threats to a business and its stakeholders because of changes in technological factors.
	Ethical factors	• distinguish between the law and ethics • explain ethical issues which influence a business • recommend and justify ways in which a business could improve its ethical profile • evaluate the advantages and disadvantages to a business and its stakeholders of behaving ethically.
	Legal factors	• explain the nature and purpose of legislation including employment, equality, company and partnership health and safety, data protection, intellectual property, planning, environmental, consumer protection, contract and financial conduct • evaluate ways in which a business can comply with legislation.
	Environmental factors	• describe environmental issues which influence a business • explain why a business needs to consider environmental issues • recommend and justify ways in which a business can address environmental issues • explain what is meant by sustainability • explain how a business may act in a sustainable manner • evaluate the impact and importance of sustainability to a business and its stakeholders

Area of Study	Content	Learners should be able to:
External influences	Environmental factors	• evaluate how a business may become more sustainable.
Accounting and finance within a business environment	Sources of finance	• explain sources of finance • distinguish between internal and external sources of finance to a business • distinguish between short-term and long-term sources of finance • explain how factors such as the following affect the choice of finance for a business: - time - legal structure - quantitative factors - qualitative factors - external influences • evaluate sources of finance for a business and its stakeholders.